

Chapter 9

Contentment Without Complacency

Before Eric and I (Jill) moved into our first RV, we were living in a two-bedroom apartment. While cleanliness and organization have always been important to me, I definitely wasn't minimalist back then. I carried a fondness for the boho chic aesthetic of the early 2000s and loved collecting mismatched odds and ends from yard sales, thrift stores, and consignment shops. If it was free (or inexpensive), it was for me! A common statement from friends when they came over was "There's so much to look at!" I took it as a compliment (it wasn't one) and told them "You're welcome for providing your eyes with entertainment."

I thought I was smart and creative with all the deals I got, treasures I found, and items I repurposed. And I loved the thrill of the hunt, so much so that nearly every weekend I would find myself at a garage sale buying something secondhand. I never spent much money—that was part of the bragging rights—but I also never thought about whether or not I actually needed or wanted more things.

It wasn't until we smushed ourselves into a 300-square-foot home on wheels that I started to connect my collections to my spending habits. I had done the simplifying thing (in a major way), but initially I still went to the secondhand stores because that's what I did for fun on weekends. Even though I'd just purged so many of my belongings, I kept going because it had become a habit. I quickly found it wasn't as enjoyable when I couldn't